



Fee Regulation (Beitragsordnung)

Version 1.1 | 7 October 2026

1. Status and Basis

The General Assembly (Mitgliederversammlung) adopts this Fee Regulation (Beitragsordnung) under § 5 Abs. 2 and § 7 Abs. 2 of the bylaws (Satzung). The bylaws rank above it; where the two conflict, the bylaws govern and the conflicting provision of this Regulation is without effect.

The bylaws govern:

- when contributions fall due (§ 5 Abs. 1);
- voting rights while contributions are in arrears (§ 7 Abs. 5);
- removal from the membership list for non-payment (§ 4 Abs. 10);
- the obligation to pay during a suspension (§ 4 Abs. 7);
- refunds on termination of membership (§ 4 Abs. 5).

The association charges no admission fee (Aufnahmegebühr) and no levy (Umlage). Applications, evidence, declarations, reminders and other notices under this Regulation are given in text form (Textform, § 126b BGB); email suffices.

This Regulation is written in English. The bylaws are in German and are the binding constitutional document of the association; any German version of this Regulation is a translation for information.

2. Annual Contributions

The annual contributions (Jahresbeiträge) for each contribution year, which is the calendar year, are:

Membership	Annual contribution
Ordinary members (ordentliche Mitglieder)	EUR 60
Supporting members (Fördermitglieder) who are natural persons	EUR 60
Supporting members who are legal persons	EUR 250
Ordinary and supporting members who qualify for the reduced rate (ermäßigter Beitrag) as students	EUR 24
Honorary members (Ehrenmitglieder)	exempt under § 5 Abs. 4 of the bylaws

Supporting membership carries no advertising services. The association may name supporting members in a list without particular emphasis.

3. Reduced Rate for Students

A member qualifies for the reduced rate who, on the reference date, is enrolled in a degree programme at a higher-education institution (Hochschule) in Germany or abroad. Doctoral studies do not qualify.

The reference date is 1 January of the contribution year and, for the year of admission, the date of admission.

The member provides a certificate of enrolment (Immatrikulationsbescheinigung) valid on the reference date. It is submitted to the Treasurer by 28 February of each contribution year or, for the year of admission, with the application for membership. If it is not received in time, the full contribution applies for that year.

Where the conditions for the reduced rate were not met, the member owes the difference to the full contribution.

4. Year of Admission and Changes During the Year

For the year of admission, the contribution depends on the quarter in which the member is admitted:

Admitted in	Contribution for the year of admission
January to March	the full annual contribution
April to June	three quarters of it
July to September	half of it
October to December	one quarter of it

A change during the contribution year between ordinary and supporting membership, or in eligibility for the reduced rate, takes effect from the following contribution year.

5. Payment

Contributions are paid by bank transfer to the association's account or, once the association offers it, by SEPA Core Direct Debit (SEPA-Basislastschrift).

Direct debit requires a mandate (SEPA-Lastschriftmandat), which the member grants voluntarily and may revoke at any time; the member then pays by transfer. The association announces each collection, with its date and amount, at least five calendar days in advance (Vorabankündigung). Members paying by direct debit notify changes of their bank details.

A debit that is returned or refunded does not discharge the contribution. Where a debit is returned unpaid for a reason for which the member is responsible, the member reimburses the charges the association's bank actually made for the return. Such reasons include insufficient funds, a closed account and bank details not notified.

The Board (Vorstand) determines the collection procedure. Collection dates fall no later than the dates on which contributions fall due under § 5 Abs. 1 of the bylaws.

6. Reminders

If a contribution is not paid when due, the Treasurer sends reminders (Mahnungen) on behalf of the Board. The first is sent no earlier than two weeks after the due date, the second no earlier than four weeks after the first.

Each reminder states the amount, the contribution year and the payment details, and allows at least two weeks for payment. The second reminder also contains the notice of impending removal from the membership list required by § 4 Abs. 10 of the bylaws.

7. Hardship

Applications for a reduction, waiver or deferral of contributions under § 5 Abs. 3 of the bylaws (Beitragsermäßigung, Beitragsbefreiung, Beitragsstundung) are made to the Treasurer with brief reasons. The Board may ask for evidence; it decides within four weeks of receipt and notifies the member.

A reduction or waiver applies to one contribution year; a deferral sets a new date for payment. Relief covers only contributions not yet paid.

The application and any evidence are made available only to the members of the Board and to the auditors (Kassenprüfer, § 9 Abs. 4 of the bylaws). While an application is pending, no reminders are sent.

8. Donations and Overpayments

An amount paid beyond what the member owes is a donation (Spende) where the payer designates it as such in the payment reference or in text form. A donation is recorded separately from contributions and confers no rights of membership. Any other amount paid beyond what the member owes, in particular a duplicate payment, is refunded to the payer or, with the payer's agreement, credited against the member's next contribution.

9. Entry into Force and Amendment

This Regulation entered into force on 2 October 2026 and applies to contributions falling due from that date. For those contributions, it replaces the resolution on the annual contribution adopted at the preliminary general assembly held before the association's founding.

Version 1.1 enters into force on the date of its adoption.

A change to the amounts applies from the contribution year following the resolution that makes it, unless that resolution provides otherwise.